I still wanted to take time to lock something that would truly give me scope to perform," she notes. That opportunity came her way in 2022 with two strong-headed, driven protagonists—Kashaf and Radha. Much like them, she has learned to stand up for herself.

What Pilgaonkar needs is a big screen break, like her *Mirzapur* co-star Vikrant Massey recently experienced with *12th Fail*. "More than restart, for me it is shifting gears," she says. "I want to get parts which surprise people. I feel I am on the cusp of something exciting. What that is, I don't know yet." It's in the not knowing that Pilgaonkar finds endless possibilities. ■

–Suhani Singh



INDIA AT CANNES 2024

The **2024 Cannes Film Festival** marks the first time in 30 years that India has a feature film in the Palme d'Or competition section. And there's lots more...



Sister Midnight

Karan Kandhari's British production will be premiered in the Directors' Fortnight section. Radhika Apte stars as a newly married woman in a Mumbai slum. Circumstances make her set out for revenge in what the makers promise is "a fantastical punk comedy, a feminist revenge film, and a revamped vampire movie rolled into one".



Santosh

Sandhya Suri's feature film, premiering in the Un Certain Regard section, follows a widowed woman (Shahana Goswami) who gets her husband's job of being a police constable in rural north India. She gets drawn into the investigation of a rape and murder of a low-caste girl by a charismatic, feminist inspector.



Sunflowers Were the First Ones to Know

Film and Television Institute of India student Chidanand Naik's short film about an elderly woman stealing a village rooster and her family being exiled in return as per prophecy competes in the La Cinef section, which highlights entries from film schools.

In Retreat

This 74-minute film, set in Ladakh, from director Maisam Ali, filmmaker Payal Kapadia's FTII (Film and Television Institute of India) batchmate, will premiere in the Cannes sidebar programme ACID (Association for the Diffusion of Independent Cinema). Harish Khanna stars as an urban nomad who returns to his hometown in the mountains. His reconciliation with his past is underscored by acclaimed Palestinian poet Mahmoud Darwish's works.



All We Imagine as Light

Set in Mumbai, this drama by Kapadia, stars Kani Kusruti and Divya Prabha. It follows her film *A Night of Knowing Nothing*, which won the Best Documentary award at the 2021 Cannes Film Festival. It will be competing for the coveted Palme D'Or against entries by world cinema heavyweights such as Francis Ford Coppola, Jia Zhangke, David Cronenberg and Yorgos Lanthimos.

–Devarsi Ghosh

